

The background of the entire page is a soft-focus photograph of several wooden chess pieces on a chessboard. The pieces are made of a light-colored wood and are arranged in a way that suggests a game in progress. The lighting is warm and even, highlighting the textures of the wood and the smooth surfaces of the pieces.

CHESS COACH READY™

MODULE 6 OF 6

Season Planning & Student Management Toolkit™

Every organizational tool for running your course or season.

Welcome to Module 6

If you've built your technical curriculum in Modules 1–3, developed your mental training framework in Module 4, and refined your tournament preparation system in Module 5 — this is the module that ties everything together into a running, repeatable program.

Most coaches are excellent at chess. Fewer are excellent at running a chess coaching business or school program with the same rigor they apply to the board. The result is familiar: scattered spreadsheets, progress tracked inconsistently (or not at all), season planning reinvented from scratch every September, and parent communications that happen reactively rather than by design.

What You'll Solve

No more rebuilding your season plan from zero each year — every template here is reusable and structured.

What You'll Walk Away With

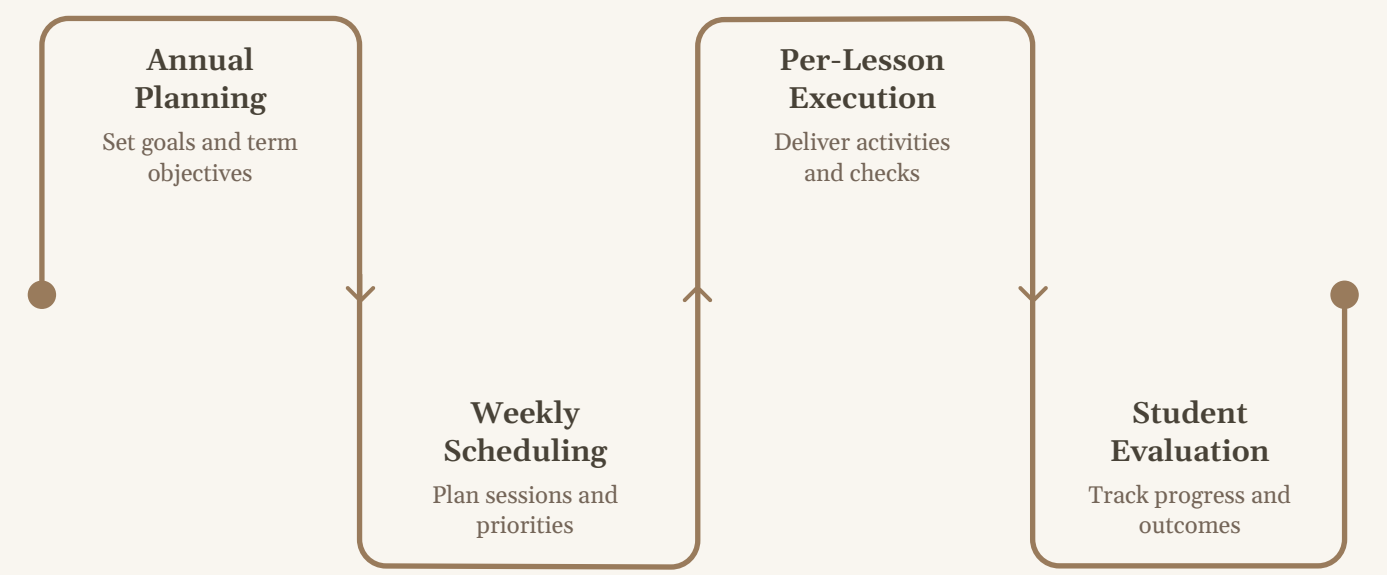
A complete, professional-grade planning and tracking system covering every student and every session.

Who This Is For

Private coaches, school club directors, competitive team coaches — any setting where students are tracked over time.

How to Use This Toolkit

This module is organized around four planning layers that mirror how professional coaches actually think about time. Each layer feeds the next — and together, they create a system that runs without you reinventing the wheel each term.



Use the templates in sequence when building a new program from scratch, or drop into any layer to address a specific gap in your current system. Every template references specific content categories from Modules 1–5, so your organizational system stays directly connected to your instructional content.

Annual & Term Layer Map your full year across technical themes, mental training, and tournament blocks. Revisit once per term.	Weekly Layer Organize students and groups across your coaching week. Manage conflicts, make-ups, and recurring slots.
Lesson Layer Plan individual sessions using a reusable sheet tied to your Module 1–5 content categories.	Evaluation Layer Track student progress, rating changes, goals, and parent communication on a structured, ongoing basis.

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Every template in this module is designed to be printed, duplicated, or adapted into your preferred digital tool. Fields marked with brackets [] are fillable by design.

Why Your Chess Program Needs Organizational Rigor

Teaching chess is a craft. Running a chess program is a discipline. These are related but distinct skills — and the gap between them is where most good coaches lose students, income, and momentum. A well-run program isn't just organized for the coach's convenience; it signals professionalism to students and parents, creates consistent learning conditions, and allows you to scale without burning out.

Consider how any structured course operates: a music conservatory, a martial arts academy, a math tutoring program. Each has defined levels, clear advancement criteria, documented content sequences, and tracking systems. Chess coaching at a professional level demands the same rigor — not because chess is less creative than those disciplines, but because structure is what makes creativity teachable over time.

1 Students progress faster

When you know exactly what was covered last session and what comes next, there's no drift — only forward momentum.

2 Retention improves

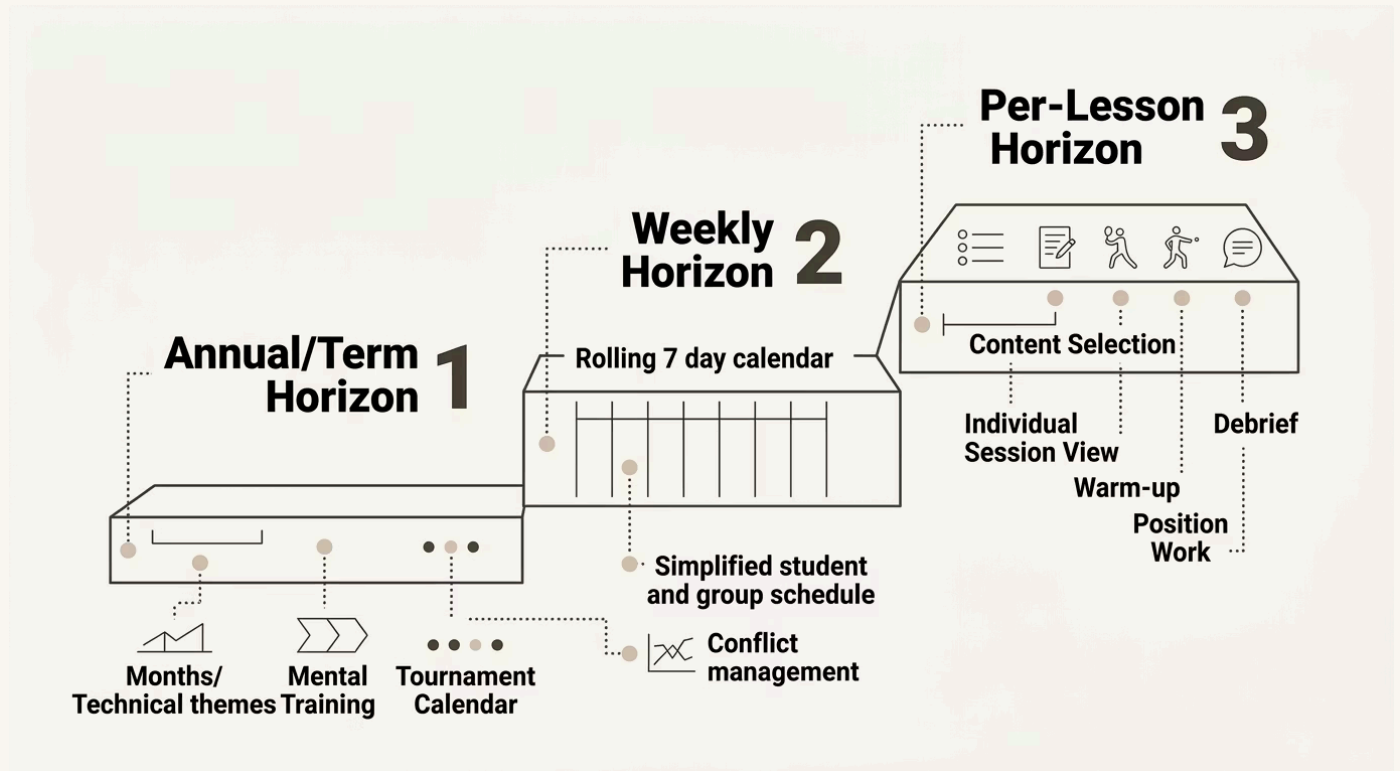
Organized programs feel valuable. Students and parents renew when they can see a structured path, not just isolated lessons.

3 You grow professionally

Documentation makes you a better coach — reviewing what worked and what didn't is only possible when you have a record.

The Three Planning Horizons

Every template in this module lives at one of three planning horizons. Understanding how they connect ensures your tactical curriculum decisions at the lesson level actually serve the long-term development goals you set at the annual level.



Annual connects to Weekly

Your yearly theme map tells you which technical cluster — tactics, endgames, opening repertoire — is the focus this month. Your weekly schedule then ensures those themes appear in every student's plan.

Weekly connects to Per-Lesson

Once you know this week's focus, the per-lesson sheet gives you a structured frame: what problem set, which concept introduction, which training game format matches the weekly theme.

Adapting Planning to Your Program Type

This toolkit supports four distinct coaching environments. The templates are the same across all four — what changes is how you configure them. Knowing your program type before you fill in any template will save you significant rework.



Private (One-on-One)

Fully individualized pacing. Every template is student-specific. Rating progress is the clearest performance signal. Parent communication is direct and frequent.



Small Group (2–6 Students)

Templates are group-wide for scheduling, individual for evaluation. Managing level spread within the group is the key challenge addressed in Section 6.



School / Club Program

Largest group size (7–30+). Requires roster management, attendance tracking, and a clear policy for students joining mid-term. Term-based planning aligns with the school calendar.

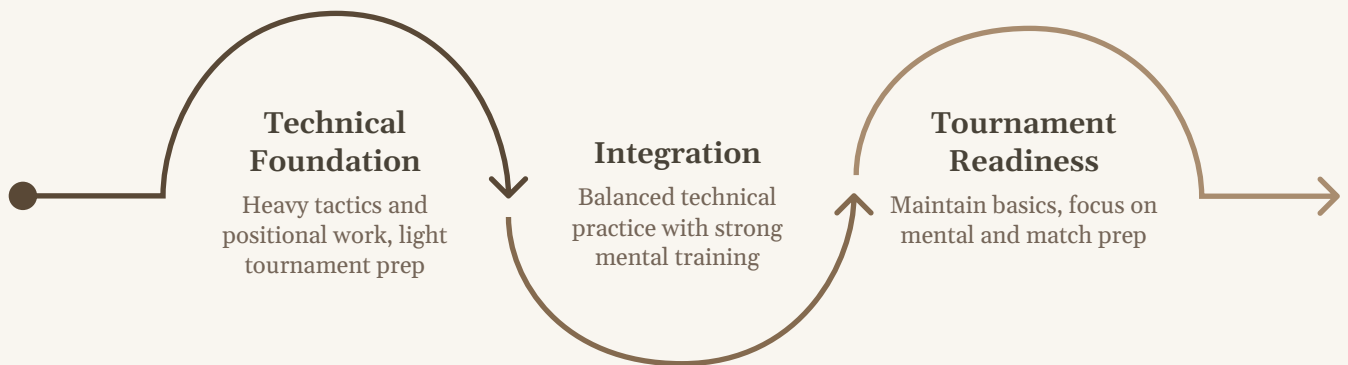


Competitive Team

Tournament schedule drives the annual plan. Technical and mental preparation must be explicitly periodized around rated events. Team communication templates are essential.

Balancing Content Across a Full Season

One of the most common structural errors in chess coaching programs is overloading tactics (Modules 1–3 content) while underweighting mental preparation (Module 4) and tournament-specific preparation (Module 5). A well-designed season treats all three as co-equal pillars that rotate in emphasis by phase of the year.



Technical Content (Modules 1–3)

- Front-load new concepts early in a term
- Taper new material in the 4–6 weeks before major events
- Use review and drilling in the final approach to tournaments

Mental & Tournament Prep (Modules 4–5)

- Introduce mental preparation frameworks in the first third of a term
- Increase time-pressure training and game analysis as events approach
- Reserve the final week pre-tournament for confidence-building work only

Common Program-Management Mistakes — and How This Toolkit Prevents Them

No Written Plan Coaching entirely from intuition produces inconsistent results and uneven student development. The Annual Template in Section 3 eliminates this in one sitting.	 Inconsistent Tracking Progress only becomes visible over time. Without a rating log and evaluation form, you lose the data that justifies your program and motivates your students.	 Reactive Scheduling Handling every make-up and conflict ad hoc burns coach time and frustrates families. The make-up policy template in Section 4 turns this into a repeatable system.
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 The goal of this toolkit is to move you from reactive to proactive — so your coaching energy goes into chess, not administration.

Full-Year Program Overview Template

— Introduction

The Full-Year Program Overview is the single most important document in this toolkit. Fill it in once per year, review it once per term, and you will always know where you are in your program and what comes next. It maps technical themes, mental training phases, and tournament season across 12 months on a single reference document.

This template works for all four program types. For school/club programs, align Month 1 with the first month of the academic year. For private coaching, Month 1 is whenever the student begins their annual cycle.

01

Map Your Tournament Calendar First

Anchor the year around known rated events, scholastic championships, and local club tournaments. Everything else positions relative to these fixed points.

03

Layer in Mental Training Phases

Using Module 4 content, map when you'll introduce concentration training, pre-game routines, and resilience work relative to tournament peaks.

02

Assign Technical Theme Blocks

Divide the year into 4–6 thematic phases (e.g., Tactical Patterns, Endgame Fundamentals, Opening Repertoire, Positional Play). Assign each phase a month range.

04

Identify Review and Assessment Points

Mark at least two formal evaluation windows per year — mid-year and end-of-year. These anchor the Student Evaluation Forms in Section 5.

Full-Year Program Overview — Template Fields

Month	Technical Theme	Mental Training Focus	Tournament / Event	Evaluation / Notes
Month 1	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 2	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 3	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 4	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 5	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 6	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	MID-YEAR EVAL
Month 7	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 8	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 9	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 10	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 11	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	[Notes]
Month 12	[Theme]	[Focus]	[Event]	END-OF-YEAR EVAL

Program Type: [Private / Group / School / Competitive] | Coach: [Name] | Program Year: [Year]

Full-Year Overview — Worked Example

The following is a worked example for a competitive scholastic group (Intermediate to Advanced level) running on a September–June academic year calendar. Adapt month assignments to your own program start date.

Month	Technical Theme	Mental Training Focus	Tournament / Event	Notes
Sep	Tactical Vision: Forks & Pins	Establishing routines	Season kickoff	Baseline eval
Oct	Tactical Combos & Calculation	Concentration drills	Local club tournament	—
Nov	Endgame: K+P vs K, Rook endings	Time-pressure training	State scholastic qualifier	Pre-event review week
Dec	Opening Repertoire (White)	Post-game analysis habits	—	Holiday break plan
Jan	Opening Repertoire (Black)	Resilience & recovery	Regional invitational	—
Feb	Positional Play: Pawn Structure	Pre-game routine lock-in	—	Mid-year eval
Mar	Piece Activity & Coordination	Visualization training	State championship	Taper new content
Apr	Complex Middlegames & Plans	Peak performance prep	National qualifier	Confidence focus
May	Game Review & Pattern Library	Full pre-game routine	National championship	Minimal new content
Jun	Season debrief & next-year prep	Post-season reflection	End-of-year club event	End-of-year eval

Full-Year Overview — Completion Guide

Once your template is filled in, use these checkpoints to validate the quality of your annual plan before the season begins.



Tournament Anchors Placed?

Every major rated event your students will enter should appear in the Tournament column before you fill in anything else. The plan builds around these dates, not the reverse.



Content Balance Checked?

Count months assigned to tactics, endgames, openings, and positional play. No single category should dominate more than 40% of the year without intentional reason.



Mental Training Present?

Every month should have at least a minimal mental training theme from Module 4. If the column is blank for 3+ consecutive months, revise your plan.



Evaluation Windows Set?

Confirm at least two formal evaluation months are marked. These anchor your student communication, goal reviews, and parent report schedule.



File your completed Full-Year Overview where you can access it in 30 seconds. If it's buried in a folder, it won't function as a reference tool.

Term / Semester Planning Template — Introduction

Most programs run on a term or semester rhythm — 10 to 16 weeks per block, two to three blocks per year. The Term Planning Template breaks your annual overview into actionable, week-by-week commitments. It operates one level below the Full-Year Overview and one level above the individual Lesson Planning Sheet.

A well-constructed term plan makes your weekly prep faster, reduces the chance of content gaps, and ensures that students in the same group receive a coherent progression rather than a collection of disconnected lessons.

Term Length

Define the term in calendar weeks (typically 10–16). Mark holidays, school breaks, and scheduled tournament weeks explicitly — these are not teaching weeks.

Primary Objective

State one primary technical objective and one primary mental training objective for the entire term. Every lesson should connect to at least one of these.

Weekly Content Column

For each teaching week, assign a specific topic or skill focus drawn from your annual theme. This is the engine of the lesson planning that follows in Section 4.

Assessment Markers

Mark the weeks in which you'll administer timed puzzle sets, tactical assessments, or position tests. These data points feed directly into the Student Evaluation Form in Section 5.

Term Planning Template — Fields & Structure

Term: [Fall / Spring / Summer] | **Year:** [] | **Program Type:** [Private / Group / School / Competitive]

Term Duration: [] weeks | **Primary Technical Objective:** [] | **Primary Mental Training Objective:** []

We ek	Technical Focus	Mental Training Element	Special Notes	Assessment?
1	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
2	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
3	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
4	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
5	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
6	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
7	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
8	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
9	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
10	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
11	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	☒ Yes ☒ No
12	[Topic]	[Element]	[Notes]	END-OF-TERM

Term Planning — Worked Example

12-week Fall term for a **small competitive group** (Intermediate level, ages 12–16). Primary Technical Objective: *Deepen tactical pattern recognition across double attacks and back-rank themes*. Primary Mental Training Objective: *Establish a consistent pre-game routine by Week 8*.

Week	Technical Focus	Mental Training Element	Special Notes	Assessment ?
1	Knight forks — identification & geometry	Goal-setting session	Baseline puzzle test	Yes — baseline
2	Bishop and queen pins	Concentration warm-ups	—	No
3	Discovered attacks & double check	Concentration warm-ups	—	No
4	Deflection and overloading	Time-pressure tolerance intro	Practice G/30 game	Yes — timed set
5	Back-rank weaknesses — patterns	Post-game analysis habit	—	No
6	Combination themes — multi-move	Visualization board drills	Local club event	No
7	Pawn endgames — king opposition	Pre-game routine intro	—	No
8	Rook endgame: Lucena & Philidor	Pre-game routine practice	Tournament prep week	Yes — position test
9	Opening: Response to 1.e4 — system review	Resilience after loss	—	No
10	Opening: 1.d4 repertoire elements	Full routine rehearsal	—	No
11	Game review & pattern reinforcement	Peak prep confidence work	Pre-tournament taper	No
12	Term debrief & goal review	Reflection & next-term goals	End-of-term eval	Yes — full eval

Level-Specific Annual Plans — Introduction

The following three pages present fully worked annual plans differentiated by level. These are not generic outlines — they show specifically how the sequence of content from Modules 1–5 is ordered differently depending on where a student sits in their development.

Beginner

Rating range 0–800. No established repertoire. Learning piece movement, basic tactics, and fundamental endgames. Mental training focused on patience and game completion.

Intermediate

Rating range 800–1400. Functional repertoire being built. Tactics through two-move combinations. Endgame fundamentals established. Beginning to play rated events regularly.

Advanced / Tournament Track

Rating range 1400+. Established repertoire. Calculating 3–5 move sequences reliably. Active tournament schedule. Mental preparation and tournament-specific strategy are primary concerns.

 These plans are models, not mandates. Every student develops at their own pace. Use these as starting templates and adjust based on individual evaluation results from Section 5.

Beginner Annual Plan — Worked Example

BEGINNER TRACK

RATING: 0–800

Month	Technical Theme	Mental Training	Tournament / Milestone
1	Piece movement & board geometry	Playing to completion — no resigning early	First casual rated game
2	Check, checkmate, and stalemate patterns	Sitting still and thinking before moving	—
3	Material value & basic trades	Handling losses constructively	Club or school event
4	One-move tactics: forks, captures, threats	Time management basics — G/30 exposure	—
5	Opening principles: center, development, castling	Pre-move habit: "Is this move safe?"	Scholastic beginner section
6	Basic pawn endgames: king and pawn	Mid-year reflection on goals	Mid-year evaluation
7	Two-move tactics: simple combinations	Staying calm when behind	—
8	Rook activation and open files	Post-game self-analysis habit	Club event
9	Simple checkmate patterns: back rank, two rooks	Visualization: seeing one move ahead	—
10	Opening: simple e4/e5 structure understanding	Routine reinforcement before games	Second scholastic event
11	Pattern review and game-based consolidation	Building confidence — highlight wins	—
12	Year debrief — what worked, next goals	Annual goal review with student	End-of-year evaluation

Intermediate Annual Plan — Worked Example

 INTERMEDIATE TRACK

RATING: 800–1400

Month	Technical Theme	Mental Training	Tournament / Milestone
1	Tactical pattern review — all basic themes	Goal-setting and term overview	Opening rated event
2	Two- and three-move combinations	Concentration: timed puzzle sets	—
3	Pawn structure: isolated, doubled, passed pawns	Time-pressure drills (G/15 practice)	Local tournament
4	Piece coordination — knights and bishops	Post-game analysis with coach review	—
5	Rook endgames: Lucena and Philidor positions	Pre-game routine introduction	Regional qualifier
6	Opening repertoire — White system deepened	Mid-year goal review	Mid-year evaluation
7	Opening repertoire — Black responses	Routine consolidation	—
8	Middlegame plans: weak squares, outposts	Resilience after tournament losses	Club championship
9	Calculation: candidate moves and elimination	Visualization board exercises	—
10	Converting advantages: technique and technique	Peak performance mental framework	State championship
11	Complex position analysis and game review	Full pre-game routine rehearsal	National qualifier
12	Annual debrief — rating review, next-level goals	Post-season reflection	End-of-year evaluation

Advanced / Tournament Track Annual Plan — Worked Example

● ADVANCED TRACK

RATING: 1400+

Month	Technical Theme	Mental Training	Tournament / Milestone
1	Opening repertoire — depth review, novelty prep	Pre-season goal-setting with rating targets	Competitive season opens
2	Deep calculation: 4–6 move sequences	Candidate-move discipline under pressure	Invitational / open tournament
3	Strategic planning: long-term pawn structures	Time management in classical formats	—
4	Endgame mastery: complex rook and minor piece	Recovery from tournament setbacks	Major rated event
5	Tournament game analysis — own games	Emotional regulation: winning vs. losing streaks	—
6	Opponent preparation techniques	Mid-year rating and goal review	Mid-year evaluation + major event
7	Transition play: middlegame to endgame technique	Peak performance visualization	—
8	Complex tactical motifs in practical positions	Pre-game routine refinement	State / regional championship
9	Defending difficult positions — technique	Board vision drills under fatigue	—
10	Opening preparation for specific opponents	Full mental competition protocol	National / peak event
11	Post-peak consolidation — review and reset	Post-season processing	—
12	Next-year preview — gap analysis and new goals	Annual reflection exercise	End-of-year evaluation

Weekly Schedule Template — Introduction

The Weekly Schedule Template is your operational command center during a live coaching season. It answers the most practical question you face each week: who am I teaching, when, what are we working on, and how does this session connect to each student's overall plan?

This template works across all program types. For private coaches with 10–20 individual students, it becomes a structured session list. For school/club directors, it maps groups across multiple time slots and rooms. For competitive team coaches, it integrates tournament prep windows into the regular weekly rhythm.

Session Blocks

List every session in the week by day and time.

Include student or group name, session length, and location.

Content Focus Column

Link each session to the weekly theme from your Term Plan. One sentence is enough — this is a planning reference, not a lesson script.

Status Column

Mark each session as Confirmed / Rescheduled / Cancelled. Update this in real time. It feeds directly into your attendance records and make-up log.

Weekly Schedule Template — Fields

Week of: [Date] | Weekly Technical Theme: [] | Weekly Mental Training Element: []

Day / Time	Student / Group	Level	Duration	Status	Session Focus
Mon [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
Mon [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
Tue [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
Tue [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
Wed [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
Thu [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
Thu [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
Fri [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
Sat [:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]
[:]	[Name / Group]	[Beg/Int/Adv]	[mins]	☐ Conf ☐ Rsch ☐ Canc	[Topic]

Make-Ups Pending: [List students with outstanding make-up sessions and target dates]

Weekly Schedule — Worked Example

Week of: October 14 | Weekly Theme: *Knight forks & discovered attacks* | Mental Element: *Concentration warm-ups (2-min blindfold drill)*

Day / Time	Student / Group	Level	Durati on	Status	Session Focus
Mon 4:00 PM	Student A	Beginner	60 min	Confirmed	One-move forks, piece captures
Mon 5:15 PM	Student B	Interme diate	75 min	Confirmed	Knight forks + 2-move combinations
Tue 4:00 PM	Group Alpha (4)	Interme diate	90 min	Confirmed	Forks & discovered checks — drills
Wed 5:00 PM	Student C	Advance d	90 min	Confirmed	Complex combinations + game analysis
Thu 4:00 PM	Student D	Beginner	60 min	Reschedul ed → Oct 17	Make-up: basic checks and captures
Thu 5:30 PM	Student E	Interme diate	75 min	Confirmed	Discovered attack patterns
Sat 10:00 AM	Group Beta (6)	Beginner /Int	120 min	Confirmed	Mixed: basic tactics + group training game

Make-Ups Pending: Student D (Oct 17, 4:00 PM — confirmed)

Lesson Planning Sheet — Introduction

The Lesson Planning Sheet is your per-session tool. It takes the weekly theme from your Term Plan and translates it into a concrete 45–90 minute session structure. It references content categories directly from Modules 1–5 so that every lesson decision is intentional and documented.

Fill this in for every session, or at minimum for every new lesson type you're delivering. Over a season, your completed sheets become a searchable library of lesson designs that you can recycle with future students at the same level.

1

Warm-Up (5–10 min)

Blindfold board recall, timed puzzle, or opening position quiz. Activates focus before main content.

2

Concept Introduction (15–20 min)

New pattern, theme, or technique drawn from the weekly focus. Demonstrate with model games or constructed positions.

3

Drill / Practice (20–30 min)

Student solves problems independently or in a timed set. Coach observes and records error patterns.

4

Game or Position Review (10–15 min)

Apply the lesson concept in a game position or play a training game. Debrief with the student immediately after.

Lesson Planning Sheet — Template Fields

Field	Entry
Date	[]
Student / Group	[]
Level	☒ Beginner ☒ Intermediate ☒ Advanced
Session Length	[] minutes
Module Content Reference	☒ M1: Tactics ☒ M2: Positional ☒ M3: Openings/Endgames ☒ M4: Mental ☒ M5: Tournament Prep
Primary Lesson Objective	[By end of session, student will be able to...]
Warm-Up Activity	[Activity description and duration]
Concept / Material to Present	[Positions, patterns, or examples to show]
Drill / Problem Set	[Puzzle source or constructed positions — number of problems]
Practice Game / Position	[Training game format, position to set up, or game to review]
Error Patterns Observed	[What did the student miss or mishandle?]
Follow-Up for Next Session	[What should be reviewed or reinforced next time?]
Coach Notes	[Any additional observations on student engagement, attitude, or progress]

Lesson Planning Sheet — Worked Example

Field	Entry
Date	October 15
Student / Group	Student B
Level	Intermediate
Session Length	75 minutes
Module Content Reference	M1: Tactics (knight forks, discovered attacks)
Primary Lesson Objective	Student will correctly identify knight fork setups in 8/10 test positions and articulate why the target squares are vulnerable.
Warm-Up Activity	2-min blindfold drill: visualize knight moves from d4 — name all squares reachable in one move. (5 min)
Concept / Material to Present	Show 3 model positions demonstrating how to "create" a fork by driving a piece to an exposed square. Emphasize geometry — knight targets squares of opposite color to its current position. (15 min)
Drill / Problem Set	12 timed tactical puzzles: forks in 1–2 moves. Student has 90 sec per puzzle. Note wrong answers for debrief. (25 min)
Practice Game / Position	Set up a middlegame position with a latent fork opportunity. Student plays White and must create the fork before move 10. (20 min)
Error Patterns Observed	Missed 2 positions where opponent's queen was the fork target — didn't check for queen + rook forks, only king + queen.
Follow-Up for Next Session	Open next lesson with 3 fork puzzles targeting queen + rook. Introduce discovered attack concept — builds naturally from today's gaps.
Coach Notes	Strong concentration today. Noticeably faster than last session on pattern recognition. Ready to advance to two-step combinations.

Make-Up & Rescheduling System — Introduction

A make-up policy is not optional for a professional coaching program — it's a communication commitment that protects your time and sets clear expectations for students and families. Without one, every missed session becomes a negotiation, and those negotiations consume coaching hours you can't recover.

This section provides a ready-to-use make-up policy, a rescheduling log template, and guidance on handling the three most common scheduling conflicts: illness, holiday interruptions, and tournament conflicts.

Standard Make-Up Policy

Define your rules here and communicate them at enrollment. Recommended: 24-hour notice required for a make-up credit. Make-ups expire at end of term.

Tournament Conflicts

Competitive students miss lessons for events. Establish upfront whether tournament weeks are a scheduled pause or whether make-ups are offered. Be consistent across all students.

Holiday Blocks

Mark holiday weeks in your Term Plan before the season begins. Sessions should not be scheduled in those windows — this prevents last-minute cancellations and the expectation of make-ups.

Make-Up Policy — Sample Text

Make-Up Lesson Policy — [Your Program Name]

A make-up credit is issued when a student cancels with at least 24 hours' notice prior to their scheduled session. Cancellations with less than 24 hours' notice are not eligible for a make-up credit unless caused by documented illness or a family emergency, at the coach's discretion.

Make-up sessions must be completed within the same term in which the missed session occurred. Make-up credits do not carry over to a new term.

Tournament weeks are scheduled pauses in the lesson calendar and do not generate make-up credits unless a session is specifically scheduled within a tournament week and later cancelled.

Sessions cancelled by the coach (due to illness, travel, or emergency) are either rescheduled within the same week or credited to the following term, at no cost to the student.

Adapt the specifics — 24-hour window, term carry-over rules — to your own business model. The key is that a written policy exists and is shared with every family at enrollment.

Make-Up & Rescheduling Log — Template

Student	Original Date	Reason	Notice Given	Make-Up Date	Status
[Name]	[Date]	[Illness / Tournament / Holiday / Other]	☐ 24h+ ☐ <24h	[Date]	☐ Scheduled ☐ Complete ☐ Expired
[Name]	[Date]	[]	☐ 24h+ ☐ <24h	[Date]	☐ Scheduled ☐ Complete ☐ Expired
[Name]	[Date]	[]	☐ 24h+ ☐ <24h	[Date]	☐ Scheduled ☐ Complete ☐ Expired
[Name]	[Date]	[]	☐ 24h+ ☐ <24h	[Date]	☐ Scheduled ☐ Complete ☐ Expired
[Name]	[Date]	[]	☐ 24h+ ☐ <24h	[Date]	☐ Scheduled ☐ Complete ☐ Expired
[Name]	[Date]	[]	☐ 24h+ ☐ <24h	[Date]	☐ Scheduled ☐ Complete ☐ Expired



Review this log at the start of each week. Make-up sessions that are not proactively scheduled will quietly expire — which creates friction with families. Stay ahead of it.

Student Evaluation Form — Introduction

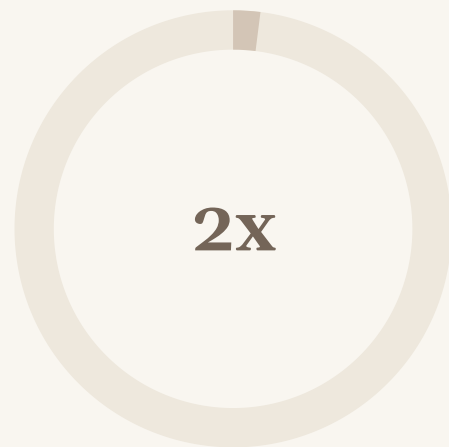
Formal evaluation is the mechanism that separates intentional coaching from improvised teaching. Without a structured evaluation process, your sense of a student's progress is impressionistic at best. With it, you have documented evidence of growth, clear identification of gaps, and a communication tool for parents that speaks for itself.

The Student Evaluation Form is designed to be completed twice per year (mid-year and end-of-year) with optional informal updates at the end of each term. It covers five performance dimensions that span the full scope of chess development — tactical, positional, opening, endgame, and mental/competitive readiness.



Evaluation Dimensions

Tactical ability, positional understanding, opening knowledge, endgame technique, mental/competitive readiness



Per Year Minimum

Complete at mid-year and end-of-year. More frequent check-ins are encouraged for students on a competitive tournament track.

Student Evaluation Form — Part 1:

Student Profile

Field	Entry
Student Name	[]
Evaluation Date	[] ☒ Mid-Year ☒ End-of-Year ☒ Term Check-In
Program Type	☒ Private ☒ Small Group ☒ School/Club ☒ Competitive Team
Level	☒ Beginner ☒ Intermediate ☒ Advanced
Current Rating (if rated)	[] Rating Organization: [USCF / FIDE / Club / Unrated]
Sessions Completed Since Last Eval	[]
Tournaments Played Since Last Eval	[]
Previous Rating (if applicable)	[]
Rating Change	[+ / –] [points]
Coach	[]

Student Evaluation Form — Part 2:

Performance Dimensions

Rate each dimension on a 1–5 scale: **1** = Not yet demonstrated | **2** = Emerging | **3** = Developing | **4** = Proficient | **5** = Mastered at current level

Dimension	Rating (1–5)	Specific Observations
Tactical Ability Pattern recognition, calculation depth, combinational accuracy	[]	[Describe specific strengths and gaps — e.g., "Reliable on 1-move forks; misses discovered attacks when the responding piece is pinned"]
Positional Understanding Pawn structure, weak squares, piece activity, plans	[]	[e.g., "Understands open files and rook placement; struggles to formulate a plan in closed positions"]
Opening Knowledge Principle application, repertoire recall, move order accuracy	[]	[e.g., "Solid on 1.e4 e5 lines; still confused after 1.d4 — needs more repertoire work on Black's responses"]
Endgame Technique King activation, pawn endgames, rook endgame fundamentals	[]	[e.g., "Lucena position — reliable; opposition in K+P endings — inconsistent"]
Mental / Competitive Readiness Time management, resilience, pre-game routine, decision-making under pressure	[]	[e.g., "Strong pre-game routine established; tends to blunder in time-pressure — needs G/15 drilling"]

Student Evaluation Form — Part 3: Summary & Next Steps

Field	Entry
Strongest Dimension This Evaluation Period	[]
Primary Gap to Address Next Term	[]
Recommended Level Adjustment?	☒ Advance to next level ☒ Continue at current level ☒ Review, slower pace needed
Tournament Readiness	☒ Ready for rated events ☒ Needs more preparation ☒ Already active competitor
Goals Set for Next Evaluation Period	[List 1–3 specific, measurable goals — see Goal-Setting Worksheet on p. 37]
Parent/Guardian Communication	☒ Report sent ☒ Meeting scheduled ☒ No communication needed this cycle
Coach Signature / Date	[] []

☒ Keep completed evaluation forms on file for each student's full coaching history. Over time, these become your most powerful evidence of program quality — and a source of coaching insight you can't get any other way.

Rating & Progress Tracker — Introduction

Rating changes are the most objective signal of chess development over time — but raw numbers without context tell an incomplete story. A student who gains 150 rating points in a year but played only two tournaments is a very different case from a student who gained 150 points across 40 rated games. This tracker captures both the data and the context.



Rating Log

Record the rating after every rated event. Include the event type, number of games played, and score (e.g., 3.5/5).



Skill Milestones

Track when a student first demonstrates a specific skill — first time holding a Philidor draw, first successful exchange sacrifice, first correct knight endgame conversion.



Tournament Results

Log every rated tournament: date, name (generic description or type), section, score, and any notable games or results worth documenting.

Rating & Progress Tracker — Template Fields

Student: [] | Season/Year: [] | Starting Rating: [] | Rating Goal for Season: []

Date	Event / Tournament	Section	Score	Rating After	Notes / Milestones
[Date]	[Event description]	[]	[]/[]	[]	[Milestone or observation]
[Date]	[Event description]	[]	[]/[]	[]	[]
[Date]	[Event description]	[]	[]/[]	[]	[]
[Date]	[Event description]	[]	[]/[]	[]	[]
[Date]	[Event description]	[]	[]/[]	[]	[]
[Date]	[Event description]	[]	[]/[]	[]	[]
[Date]	[Event description]	[]	[]/[]	[]	[]

End-of-Season Rating: [] | Net Change: [+ / –] [points] | Total Games Played: []

Rating & Progress Tracker — Worked Example

Student: Student B | **Season:** Sept–June | **Starting Rating:** 1047 | **Rating Goal:** Break 1200

Date	Event / Tournament	Section	Score	Rating	Notes / Milestones
Oct 7	Local club open	U1200	2.5/4	1071	First tournament of season — solid opening play
Nov 14	State scholastic qualifier	U1200	3/5	1098	First time converting won rook endgame in tournament play
Jan 18	Regional invitational	U1200	2/5	1082	Lost 3 close games — time pressure identified as key gap
Mar 8	State championship	U1200	4/6	1147	Best result of season — G/30 drills paid off clearly
Apr 19	National qualifier	U1300	3.5/7	1188	First event in higher section — held own against stronger players
May 24	End-of-season club event	U1300	4/5	1214	Broke 1200 goal — season complete

End-of-Season Rating: 1214 | **Net Change:** +167 points | **Total Games Played:** 32

Goal-Setting Worksheet — Template

Complete this worksheet with the student at the start of each term or season. Goals set collaboratively are goals students feel ownership over — which dramatically increases the likelihood they’ll work toward them between sessions.

Field	Entry
Student Name	[]
Term / Season	[]
Current Rating	[] Target Rating: []
Technical Goal #1	[e.g., "Solve 10 tactical puzzles per week independently and achieve 80% accuracy on knight fork sets"]
Technical Goal #2	[e.g., "Learn and memorize the first 8 moves of a Black defense to 1.e4"]
Endgame Goal	[e.g., "Reliably convert K+R vs. K to checkmate in under 20 moves from any starting position"]
Mental / Competitive Goal	[e.g., "Apply pre-game routine at every rated event this term without reminder"]
Tournament Goal	[e.g., "Score 50% or better in the U1300 section at the state qualifier"]
Personal Process Goal	[e.g., "Never move before asking 'Why is my opponent making this move?' in every game this term"]
How Will We Measure Progress?	[Specify the review method: puzzle score, game records, coach observation, rating change]
Review Date	[Mid-term:] [End-of-term:]
Student Signature / Date	[] []
Coach Signature / Date	[] []

Goal-Setting Worksheet — Worked Example

Field	Entry
Student Name	Student B
Term / Season	Fall Term (September – December)
Current Rating	1047 Target Rating: 1150
Technical Goal #1	Correctly identify knight fork setups in 8/10 test positions drawn from unfamiliar positions — not from previously seen puzzles.
Technical Goal #2	Memorize the main line of chosen Black defense to 1.e4 through move 10, with understanding of the key ideas — not just move recall.
Endgame Goal	Convert the Lucena position to a win in 100% of training attempts by end of term.
Mental / Competitive Goal	Implement full pre-game routine (board check, breathing exercise, 2-min visualization) at every rated game played this term.
Tournament Goal	Score 3.5/5 or better at the November state scholastic qualifier, U1200 section.
Personal Process Goal	"I will write down my intended plan before making my first middlegame move in every long-format game."
How Will We Measure Progress?	Weekly puzzle accuracy log, post-tournament game review, Lucena test in Week 8, coach observation notes from each session.
Review Date	Mid-term: Week 6 (October 28) End-of-term: Week 12 (December 9)

Parent/Guardian Progress Report — Template

The parent progress report is a professional communication tool, not a transcript of your coaching sessions. Keep it accessible, positive in framing, specific in content, and forward-looking. Avoid jargon; when technical terms are needed, briefly define them.

[Your Program Name] — Student Progress Report

Student: [] | Report Period: [] | Date: [] | Prepared by: []

Sessions Completed: [] sessions this term

Current Rating: [] | **Change This Period:** [+ / –] [points]

Tournaments Played: [] | **Overall Score:** [] points from [] games

Progress Highlights:

[2–3 specific observations on what the student has learned or improved. Use plain language. e.g., "This term, [Name] significantly improved at spotting tactical combinations — sequences where one move creates two threats at once. In recent games, [he/she/they] has been converting these opportunities reliably, which is a meaningful step forward."]

Areas of Focus for Next Term:

[1–2 areas. Frame constructively. e.g., "Our main priority for next term is improving time management in longer games — specifically, making confident decisions when the clock is running low. This is a normal developmental challenge at this level and we have a clear plan to address it."]

Goals for Next Term:

[List 1–3 goals from the Goal-Setting Worksheet in simple language]

Coach's Note:

[Brief personal note on the student's attitude, effort, or a specific moment of growth this term. Keep it genuine and specific — not generic praise.]

Questions? Please reach out at [contact] — I'm happy to discuss [Name]'s progress at any time.

Parent Progress Report — Worked Example

[Your Program Name] — Student Progress Report

Student: Student B | Report Period: Fall Term (Sep–Dec) | Date: December 10 | Prepared by: [Coach Name]

Sessions Completed: 11 of 12 sessions completed (1 make-up delivered)

Current Rating: 1098 | **Change This Period:** +51 points

Tournaments Played: 2 | **Overall Score:** 5.5 points from 9 games

Progress Highlights:

Student B had a strong fall term. The most notable improvement has been in tactical accuracy — recognizing and executing knight fork patterns, and connecting these tactics to longer combinations over two and three moves. In November's tournament, [he/she/they] won a critical game by finding a two-move combination that won a rook — exactly the type of pattern we worked on in October. Opening preparation has also solidified, with a reliable system in place for responses to 1.e4.

Areas of Focus for Next Term:

Time management in longer games remains the primary development priority. Student B plays well when time is comfortable but tends to rush decisions as the clock shortens. We'll address this directly through timed training games and specific drills in the January–February block.

Goals for Next Term:

1. Score 3/5 or better at the regional invitational in January. 2. Establish a consistent pre-game routine by Week 6. 3. Break 1150 rating by end of spring term.

Coach's Note:

Student B works hard and takes feedback well. The jump in rating this term reflects genuine learning, not luck — the improvement in game quality is clear across all recent sessions. I'm looking forward to next term.

Attendance & Group Roster Template

Attendance tracking serves two purposes in a professional program: it's an accountability mechanism for students and families, and it's a data source for you as a coach. When a student's performance drops, low attendance is often the first explanatory factor — and you can only see that pattern if you've been tracking it.

Student Name	Level	Wk 1	Wk 2	Wk 3	Wk 4	Wk 5	Notes
[Name]	[]	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	[]
[Name]	[]	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	[]
[Name]	[]	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	[]
[Name]	[]	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	[]
[Name]	[]	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	[]
[Name]	[]	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	[]

Key: ✓ = Present | A = Absent | M = Make-Up Scheduled | T = Tournament / Excused

Managing Mixed-Level Groups

Mixed-level groups are the reality in most school and club programs. A group spanning beginners, intermediate players, and developing competitors is not a coaching failure — it's a structural challenge that requires a deliberate differentiation strategy. The following approaches are tested and sustainable.



Universal Theme, Differentiated Difficulty

Teach the same tactical theme (e.g., pins) to the whole group using beginner positions for lower-level students and complex, multi-piece positions for stronger ones. The concept is shared; the cognitive load is differentiated.



Pairing for Training Games

Pair students with a one-level gap for training games (beginner with intermediate, intermediate with advanced). The stronger player benefits from teaching and concrete practice; the weaker player gains exposure to higher-quality play.



Tiered Problem Sets

Prepare two or three difficulty tiers of the same tactical theme. Beginners solve Tier 1 problems (one-move solutions), intermediates solve Tier 2 (two-move combinations), and advanced students solve Tier 3 (three-to-five move sequences). One session plan, three engagement levels.

Communication Templates — New Student Welcome

Professional communication sets the tone for a professional program. These templates cover the three most common communication moments in a coaching season. Adapt them to your own voice and program specifics.

Subject: Welcome to [Your Program Name] — Getting Started

Dear [Family Name],

I'm delighted to welcome [Student Name] to [Program Name]. I'm looking forward to getting to know [him/her/them] over the coming sessions.

Here's what to know before we begin:

- **First session date and time:** []
- **Location:** []
- **What to bring:** No equipment needed to start — I'll provide materials for the first session.
- **Make-Up Policy:** Please review the enclosed policy. I ask for 24-hour advance notice for any cancellations.

Over the first two or three sessions, I'll be assessing [Student Name]'s current level so I can customize the plan accordingly. After that initial period, I'll share a brief overview of the direction we'll be taking.

Any questions before we begin? Please don't hesitate to reach out at [contact].

Looking forward to it,
[Coach Name]

Communication Templates — Tournament Reminder & Season Wrap-Up

Tournament Reminder Template

**Subject: Reminder — [Tournament Type]
This [Day]**

Hi [Family Name],

This is a quick reminder that [Student Name] is registered for [tournament/event description] this [day/date].

Details:

- Date: []
- Location: []
- Arrival time: [] (please arrive 15 minutes before round 1)
- Expected finish: []
- Rounds: [] | Time control: []

A reminder to [Student Name]: run your pre-game routine before each round. We've been working on it for good reason.

Good luck — I'll follow up after the event.
[Coach Name]

Season Wrap-Up Template

Subject: Season Wrap-Up — [Student Name]

Dear [Family Name],

With the season now complete, I wanted to take a moment to reflect on what [Student Name] accomplished this year.

Season Highlights:

[2–3 specific accomplishments — rating gain, tournament result, skill milestone]

Looking Ahead:

[Brief preview of what the next term or season will focus on]

It has been a genuine pleasure coaching [Student Name] this season. The progress [he/she/they] has made — particularly in [specific area] — reflects real commitment and hard work.

I'll be in touch shortly about next season's schedule. Please don't hesitate to reach out in the meantime.

Warm regards,
[Coach Name]

Sample Season: Private / Individual Student

● BEGINNER → INTERMEDIATE TRACK

PRIVATE COACHING

Student Profile: Age 11, no prior rated experience, enrolled in private weekly coaching (60 min/week).
Goal: earn first USCF rating by end of year and understand fundamental chess patterns across all phases of the game.

Phase	Technical Focus	Mental Training	Milestones / Events
Months 1–2	Piece movement, check/checkmate patterns, material counting	Patience and game completion; handling losses as learning	First casual rated game; baseline evaluation completed
Months 3–4	One-move tactics: forks, pins, captures; opening principles	Pre-move habit: "Is this move safe?" routine introduced	First club-level event (unrated or beginner section)
Months 5–6	K+P endgames, back-rank checkmate patterns, simple combinations	Time management basics; first timed game (G/30)	Mid-year evaluation; first USCF-rated event (Scholastic)
Months 7–8	Rook activation, open files; two-move combinations	Post-game analysis habit; staying calm when material down	Second rated event; first rating published
Months 9–10	Opening system: e4/e5 structure, development sequences	Visualization: one-move-ahead mental board discipline	Third rated event; goal: score first win in rated play
Months 11–12	Pattern consolidation; game review of own games	Annual goal review; confidence highlight session	End-of-year evaluation; next-level goals set for Year 2

Sample Season: Small Competitive Group

 INTERMEDIATE TO ADVANCED TRACK

SMALL COMPETITIVE GROUP (4–6 STUDENTS)

Group Profile: Four students, ages 13–17, rated 1050–1350. Weekly group session (90 min) plus individual analysis session monthly. Goal: state championship preparation and rating improvement across the group.

Phase	Technical Focus	Mental Training	Events / Milestones
Sep–Oct	Tactical patterns: all themes reviewed; 3-move combos introduced	Goal-setting session; concentration drills; timed puzzle sets	Season opener event; baseline evaluations; group roster finalized
Nov	Endgame fundamentals: Lucena, Philidor, K+P technique	Time-pressure training; post-game analysis protocol introduced	State scholastic qualifier; pre-event taper week
Dec–Jan	Opening repertoire: White system deepened; Black responses consolidated	Pre-game routine introduction and practice	Holiday break; January regional invitational
Feb	Positional play: weak squares, pawn structure, outposts, piece coordination	Mid-year goal review; resilience module from Module 4	Mid-year individual evaluations; individual sessions for gaps
Mar–Apr	Complex middlegames; opponent preparation techniques; game review sessions	Full pre-game routine; peak performance preparation from Module 5	State championship; national qualifier; taper weeks in place
May–Jun	Post-peak consolidation; next-year gap analysis; new opening ideas previewed	Post-season reflection; individual debriefs; celebration session	National championship (qualifying students); end-of-year evaluations

Sample Season: School / Club Program

 MIXED LEVELS

SCHOOL / CLUB PROGRAM (10–25 STUDENTS)

Program Profile: 15–20 students across all levels, meeting twice weekly as a club (45 min sessions) with monthly rated club tournaments. Term-based structure aligned to school year. Two coaches or one coach with a senior student assistant.

Phase	Whole-Group Theme	Level Differentiation	Events / Admin
Sep (Wk 1–4)	Tactics: universal theme — pins and forks; tiered difficulty sets	Beginners: 1-move. Intermediates: 2-move. Advanced: combo sequences	Roster finalized; beginner orientation session; attendance system live
Oct (Wk 5–8)	Checkmate patterns: back rank, smothered mate, Anastasia’s mate family	Beginners: basic mate-in-ones. Advanced: set up and convert from middlegame positions	Monthly club tournament (Round Robin); attendance review
Nov (Wk 9–12)	Endgame basics: K+P universally; Lucena for upper level	Beginners: opposition concept. Intermediate/Adv: Philidor and Lucena positions	Term evaluations; state qualifier for upper-level students; club event
Jan (Wk 1–4)	Opening principles revisited; common opening errors and fixes	Beginners: development and castling drills. Upper levels: repertoire troubleshooting from own games	New term roster review; welcome new members; goals set for all students
Feb–Mar	Positional themes: pawn structure and piece activity; whole-group instruction	Tiered training games: same theme, different starting positions by level	Monthly tournament; mid-year evaluations; parent reports issued
Apr–Jun	Game analysis: student games reviewed with group; peer learning model	Advanced students lead analysis of own games; beginners observe and ask questions	Spring club championship; end-of-year celebration; annual evaluations; next-year planning

Quick-Reference Checklists

✓ Start of Season Checklist

- ☐ Full-Year Program Overview completed for this year
- ☐ Tournament calendar anchored in the annual plan
- ☐ Term Planning Template completed for Term 1
- ☐ Weekly Schedule Template set up and shared with relevant parties
- ☐ Student Roster finalized and attendance sheet prepared
- ☐ Baseline evaluations scheduled or completed for all students
- ☐ Goal-Setting Worksheets completed with every student
- ☐ Make-Up Policy distributed to all families
- ☐ Welcome communication sent to new students/families
- ☐ Lesson Planning Sheets prepared for Weeks 1–4
- ☐ Rating & Progress Tracker initialized for each student
- ☐ Module 1–5 content plan aligned with term theme sequence

✓ End of Season Checklist

- ☐ All Student Evaluation Forms completed
- ☐ Rating & Progress Tracker finalized (end-of-season rating recorded)
- ☐ Progress Reports sent to all parents/guardians
- ☐ Make-Up Log reviewed — all outstanding credits resolved or closed
- ☐ Attendance records filed for the season
- ☐ Goal-Setting Worksheets reviewed with each student
- ☐ Season Wrap-Up communication sent to all families
- ☐ Annual Plan reviewed — what content areas worked? What needs revision?
- ☐ Next-year tournament calendar researched and anchored
- ☐ Level advancement decisions documented for each student
- ☐ Lesson Planning Sheet library organized and filed for reuse
- ☐ Next season's Full-Year Overview drafted before final wrap-up

Master Planning Reference Sheet

This single-page reference combines all three planning layers — annual, weekly, and evaluation — into one printable overview. Use it as a coaching dashboard at the start of each week.

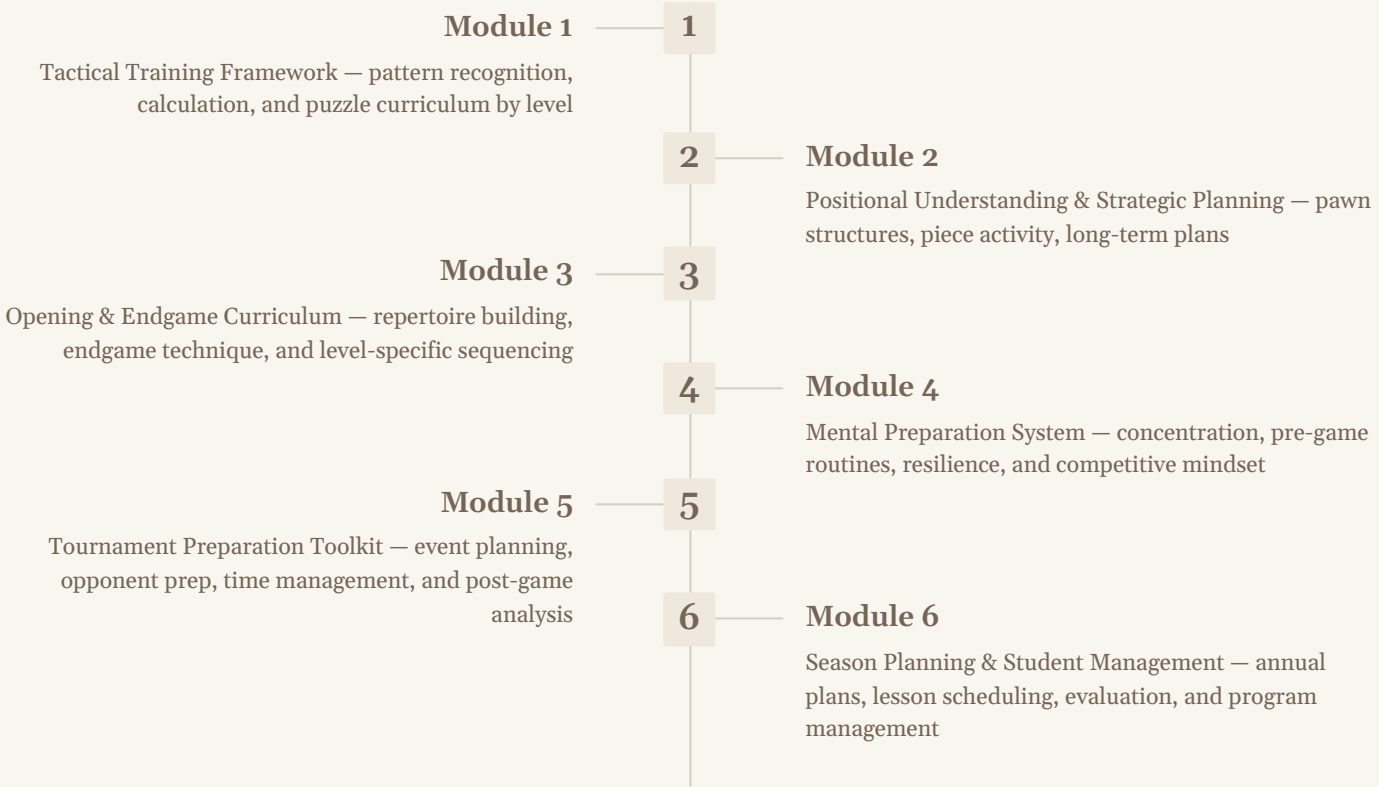
Layer	Current Status
Annual Theme (This Month)	Technical: [] Mental: [] Tournament: []
Term Focus (This Term)	Primary Technical Objective: [] Primary Mental Training Objective: [] Term Week: [] of []
This Week's Theme	Technical: [] Mental Element: []
This Week's Sessions	[List student / group + day + time + focus — 5–8 lines]
Make-Ups Pending	[Student: date / status]
Evaluations Due This Term	[Student names + target evaluation date]
Next Tournament (Any Student)	Event: [] Date: [] Students Attending: []
Parent Reports Due	[Student names + deadline]
Coach Priority This Week	[The single most important coaching or administrative action this week]

☐ Print this sheet weekly or keep it open in a digital tool. A coaching program that runs on clear priorities is a program that grows — and stays sustainable.

Chess Coach Ready™ — The Complete System

Six Modules. One Complete System.

Module 6 completes the Chess Coach Ready™ operating system. Here is how all six modules work together as one integrated program — and what you now have at your disposal as a professional chess coach.



You now have everything you need to run a chess coaching program at a professional level — not just to teach chess well, but to build and sustain an organized, trackable, scalable program that serves every student from their first lesson to their peak competitive performance.

The templates in this module are not meant to be filled in once and filed away. They are living documents — updated each term, reviewed each season, and refined year over year as your program grows and your coaching deepens. The coaches who get the most from this system are the ones who return to it regularly, not just when things go wrong.

Run your program with the same rigor and intentionality you bring to the board. Your students will feel the difference — and so will you.

 **Plan Deliberately**
Annual and term plans built before the season begins — not reconstructed after it ends.

☒ **Track Consistently**
Every student's rating, progress, and goals documented and reviewed on a structured schedule.

☒ **Communicate Professionally**
Parent reports, welcome messages, and tournament reminders that reflect the quality of your coaching.

☒ **Grow Continuously**
A filing system of lesson plans, evaluations, and season overviews that makes every future year better than the last.